

I. PROGRAM TITLE: PROJECT Better Health for Women (BHW)

II. PROPONENT: JOESAN D. BORRES, PhD-BM

III. RATIONALE/BACKGROUND:

Health is "*a complete physical, mental, and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity,*" (World Health Organization). It is an essential element of living today. As many Filipino health workers migrate to other countries, the government agency utilizes the Barangay Health Workers (BHWs) to provide healthcare services in the community (Taburnal, 2020). However, there are no clear guidelines for appointing them.

BHWs perform many tasks by bringing the health system to the community. They are committed to the community despite a lack of compensation, excessive workload, and lack of formal and structured training (Hartigan-Go et al., 2023). Despite their significance, they are ignored in some areas.

Project Better Health for Women is an extension project that seeks to offer a holistic and sustainable impact on the lives of BHWs by providing skills and livelihood training. Skills training equips them with the necessary competencies to deliver effective and efficient healthcare services such as conducting primary health assessments, providing first aid, and administering preventive measures. Giving them livelihood training as additional skills enhances their ability to address health issues and drive their entrepreneurial spirit. So, this extension project aims to contribute to the overall health and prosperity of the community.

IV. OBJECTIVES

1. To collect profile and baseline data on the needs of barangay health workers.
2. To forge a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA).
3. To identify the capacity of potential trainers based on the result of profiling and baseline data.
4. To create the training design/activity proposal for barangay health workers based on the baseline data result and potential trainers' capacity.
5. To implement the training design/activity proposal for skills training and livelihood training.
6. To monitor the delivery of the extension project.
7. To conduct a rapid impact study.
8. To present and publish the rapid impact study to contribute to the body of knowledge for future extension endeavors.

V. ACTIVITIES/METHODOLOGY

After the extension project is presented to the University In-House, the proponent will visit the local Health Unit and DSWD for data on which remote areas of the Municipality of Pilar where access to healthcare facilities may be limited and the BHWs need some training. A courtesy call will be conducted to the Barangay Captain before these five phases commence, to wit:

Phase 1: Needs Assessment

- Profiling
- Training Needs Assessment
- Inventory of Resources and Experts
- Forging MOA

Phase II: Design Phase

- Crafting of Training Design/Activity Proposal
- Crafting of IEC Materials

Phase III: Implementation

- Skills Training – basic health assessments, first aid, health education on preventive measures and preventing diseases, psycho-social support and others that may arise on TNA results
- Livelihood Training – detergent making, liquid soap making, Asuhos Spanish-style sardines, packaging and labeling, financial literacy, and others that may arise on TNA results

Phase IV: Monitoring

- Before Stage – pre-Test on skills knowledge on basic health assessments, first aid, health education, financial literacy
- During Stage – monitoring for progress check after two months the activities conducted
- After Stage – post-Test on skills knowledge on basic health assessments, first aid, health education, financial literacy

Phase V: Evaluation and Terminal

- Terminal Report
- Rapid Impact Study
- Presentation and Publication of Rapid Impact Study

VI. WORKPLAN/GANTT CHART

ACTIVITIES	YEAR 1				YEAR 2			
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q
Profiling								
Training Needs Assessment								
Inventory of available resources and experts								
MOA Forging								
Create training design/activity proposal								
Create IEC materials								
Deliver the extension program as scheduled								
Monitor the delivery of the extension project through the use of a monitoring tool								
Rapid impact study								
Presentation and Publication								

VII. OUTPUTS AND IMPACTS

The expected outputs and impacts of this proposed extension activity are that the barangay health workers know how to do the basic health assessment, can perform first aid, and encourage the community to participate in sound public health by practicing preventive measures to prevent diseases and awareness of mental health. Similarly, it will boost its entrepreneurial spirit by engaging in income-generating activities by selling handmade powder detergent, liquid soap, and Asuhos Spanish-style sardines.

VIII. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The extension project will be monitored every two months after the training is conducted using the monitoring tool for progress checking. A pre-test assessment will be conducted before the implementation, a post-test assessment will be conducted during the implementation, and a rapid impact study will be conducted after the complete implementation of the project.

IX. BUDGET

Proposed Budget for Training Materials

Item	Price	Quantity	Total
Digital Body Thermometer	300	3	900.00
Fingertip Pulse Oximeter Blood Oxygen Saturation Monitor	1000	3	3,000.00
Basic First Aid Kit	500	3	1,500.00
Powder Detergent Kit 5 kilo with add-ons: scent, extra foam booster, extra surfactant, extra stain remover	2000	3	6,000.00
Dishwashing Liquid Kit 15-16 Liters with add-ons: degreaser and foam booster	1000	2	2,000.00
100 pcs 500 grams Detergent Powder Plastic Packaging Plain	300	10	3,000.00
Fresh Asuhos	400	10	4,000.00
Olives			400.00
Pickles			600.00
Garlic			200.00
Carrot			400.00
Bay Leaves			100.00
Peppercorn			100.00
Chili Flakes			400.00
Salt			100.00
Sugar			100.00
Vinegar			200.00
Palm Oil, 1 gallon	1,300	3	3,900.00
Beehive Style Plastic Jar with yellow cap, 250ml	250	30	7,500.00
500 mL bottle, regular cap, 12 pcs per box	300	4	1,200.00
Sticker paper, A4, 105gsm	200	10	2,000.00
Coupon bond, long	300	2	600.00
Blue ballpen	200	1	200.00
Manila Paper	30	10	300.00
Pentel pen, 1 box	600	1	600.00
Certificates, long, 170gsm	50	60	3,000.00
Black Ink, Epson L3110	600	2	1,200.00
Presentation and Publication			50,000.00
Grand Total			93,500.00

References:

World Health Organization, www.who.org

Hartigan-Go, Kenneth and Valenzuela, Sheena and Prieto, Melissa Louise, Important but Neglected: A Qualitative Study on the Lived Experiences of Barangay Health Workers in the Philippines (April 2023). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4461587> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4461587>

Taburnal, Maria Visitacion M. (2020). Knowledge and Competence of Barangay Health Workers (BHWs), International Journal of Innovation, Creativity and Change, Volume 14, Issue 1.